Moving ChadaTech to Scrum

Lessons from the SNHU Travel pilot

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THE PILOT

The SNHU Travel pilot at a glance

6
user stories in the Product Backlog

3
detailed stories with acceptance criteria

6
test cases, three written and three revised

2
changes in direction during the project

5
weeks on the client's timeline



The client
SNHU Travel wants to grow with niche vacation packages and asked for a working booking site in five weeks.



How I worked
One role at a time: Product Owner, Developer, Tester, and now Scrum Master for this review.

AGILE ROLES

Four roles, one owner for each decision



Product Owner

Owns the Product Backlog and decides what the team builds next.

Pilot: ranked six focus group stories



Scrum Master

Runs the Scrum events, coaches the team, and clears impediments.

Pilot: routed new work through Christy



Developer

Builds a usable increment every Sprint and owns the Sprint Backlog.

Pilot: built the list and slide show



Tester

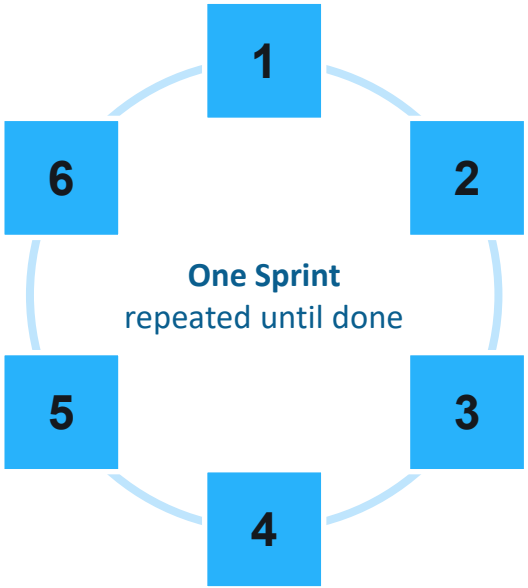
Turns acceptance criteria into pass and fail checks.

Pilot: revised tests for the wireframe

In Scrum, developers and testers together form the Developers. Stakeholders such as Amanda sit outside the team and shape the backlog at the Sprint Review (Coleman, 2024; Jocham et al., 2025). Clear roles keep the team close to those needs (Verwijs & Russo, 2023).

AGILE PHASES

Agile repeats every SDLC phase each Sprint



1. **Plan and analyze:** pick the highest-value stories and agree on a Sprint Goal.
2. **Design:** sketch only what this Sprint needs, such as one wireframe.
3. **Code:** build a small piece of working software.
4. **Test:** check each acceptance criterion inside the Sprint, not after it.
5. **Deploy:** deliver a usable increment the client can try.
6. **Review and maintain:** feedback and the Retrospective shape the next Sprint.

Phase names follow Jackson et al. (2025).

AGILE PHASES

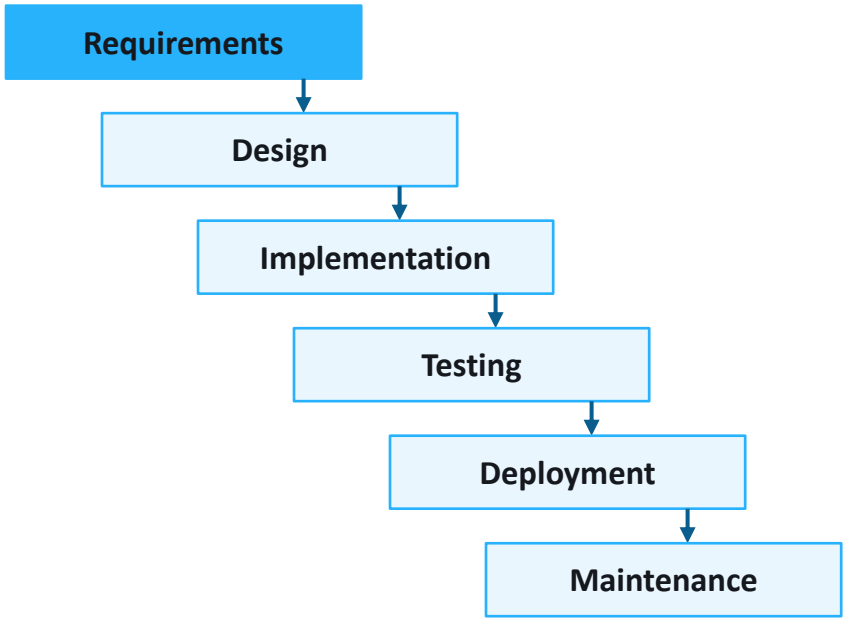
How the phases ran on SNHU Travel

Phase	What we did on SNHU Travel	Where it happens in Scrum
Plan and analyze	Turned the focus group into six ranked, sized user stories	Backlog refinement, Sprint Planning
Design	Christy shared a wireframe with one destination per slide	Sprint Planning
Code	Built the Top Five list, then the wellness slide show	The Sprint, Daily Scrum
Test	Wrote three test cases, then revised all three for the wireframe	The Sprint, Daily Scrum
Deploy	Exported a runnable JAR so the Tester ran the same build	End of the Sprint
Review and maintain	Demo the increment to Amanda; agree on one improvement	Sprint Review, Sprint Retrospective

Every phase showed up in every Sprint, just at a smaller size.

WATERFALL MODEL

Waterfall runs each phase once, in order



Work moves in one direction.
Each phase is finished before the next begins, so a late change goes back up the chain.
(Jackson et al., 2025)

The client sees results late.
Customers mostly take part during planning at the start and evaluation at the end.
(Mishra & Alzoubi, 2023)

Best for stable requirements.
It fits when the requirements are well defined and unlikely to change.
(Mishra & Alzoubi, 2023)

Each phase is signed off before the next one starts.

The wellness change under each approach

Midway through the project, SNHU Travel moved the booking tool to detox and wellness travel.

Under Scrum: what happened

1. Christy kept the finished work and changed only the vacation types.
2. I kept the slide show navigation and swapped in five wellness trips.
3. My questions went to Christy and the Tester before the Daily Scrum.
4. Test cases were updated in the same Sprint as the code.

Under waterfall: what it would take

1. Requirements were already signed off, so a formal change request starts.
2. Design documents are reopened and approved again.
3. Code written to the old plan gets reworked after approval.
4. Testing waits until the end, when defects cost the most to fix.

Cost under Scrum: one updated slide show and a revised set of test cases.

Choosing waterfall or Agile

Factor	Agile fits when	Waterfall fits when	SNHU Travel pilot
Requirement stability	Needs will change as users see the product	Requirements are known and stable at the start	**Changed twice in five weeks**
Client involvement	The client can review work every Sprint	The client is mainly available at the start and end	**Amanda reviews each increment**
Size and team spread	A small team that works closely together	A large project with teams spread across sites	**One small Scrum Team**
Cost of late change	Late changes must stay cheap	Change is rare and formally controlled	**The wellness change came mid-project**
Delivery timeline	The client needs working software early	One full release on a fixed date is acceptable	**Five-week deadline**

Factors 1 to 3 draw on Mishra and Alzoubi (2023). Factors 4 and 5 come from the pilot. Every row pointed SNHU Travel toward Agile.

RECOMMENDATION

Adopt Scrum and keep a plan-driven option

01

Use Scrum for evolving work

Client projects whose needs will shift, like SNHU Travel, which absorbed two changes without a restart.

02

Keep waterfall for fixed scope

Stable, well-defined work with formal sign-offs still fits a plan-driven or hybrid model (Mishra & Alzoubi, 2023).

03

Carry the pilot's lessons

Write acceptance criteria with measurable limits, keep decisions on a shared board, and protect the Product Owner's time.

SOURCES

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